Carthage R9 School District



Carthage Dual Language Academy

Guidelines/Application

2024-2025

Carthage R9 School District

Carthage, MO

Carthage Dual Language Academy
Program Information

The Carthage Dual Language Academy is a two-way immersion dual language program in Spanish and English. For the 2024-2025 school year, the program will operate in Kindergarten through Grade 10 . The program is offered at Fairview Elementary School, Carthage Intermediate Center, the Carthage Sixth Grade Center, Carthage Jr. High, and Carthage High School.

Two-way immersion is a form of dual language that combines students from two language groups while providing instruction in both languages. Each class is composed of approximately one-half of students with Spanish as an initial language and one-half students with English as an initial language. Students will learn the academic curriculum through both languages. Students serve as language models for each other while accelerating their own learning.

The primary goal of the dual language program is to allow all students to realize the full benefits of bilingualism which include enhanced cognitive ability, increased academic achievement, heightened multicultural appreciation and understanding, and a competitive edge in the increasingly global society of the 21st century.

Goals of the Program:

- High Academic Achievement for All
- Bilingualism/Biliteracy
- Cross-cultural Competency
- Marketable 21st Century Skills

Elementary Program Information:

- There are two classes per grade level through Grade 6.
- Languages are completely separated by teacher, classroom, and periods of instruction.
- *50% of instruction will be in Spanish and 50% of instruction will be in English*
- Class size remains at 20-22 students, with an approximate 50% balance between language groups kept as close as possible.
- State and district learning standards and curriculum are taught, although some materials may vary from other classrooms.
- Students' reading, writing, and oral language are assessed in Spanish and English.
- It is strongly recommended that the parent/student commit to the program through grade 6 (to reach grade level proficiency in both languages).

- Parents do not need to have bilingual skills for student participation in the program.
- Students may need to be available for assessment prior to the school year.
- Parents are required to attend at least one informational meeting prior to enrolling their child in the program.
- Siblings of students who are already enrolled in the program will be given priority placement upon enrollment when enrolling their kindergarten year. Siblings MUST enroll prior to March 1 to be given priority placement.

Kindergarten Entry Considerations

- If a student is recommended for Tiger Prep Academy, it is strongly recommended that he or she attend this program before they enter the dual language program. Kindergarten readiness is a key to success in any kindergarten program, but particularly important for one that is more demanding.

- If a student is retained, they will not repeat the year in the dual language program. That seat will be given to a child coming into that grade. However, the child may apply to return to the program the following year IF they meet the criteria and there is an available seat.

Jr. High Program Information

- Spanish Language Arts will be offered at each grade level. This is an elective course.
- Math will be offered in Spanish in Grade 7 (2024-2025)
- Students may enroll in either Spanish Language Arts, DL Math, or both.
- The content course being offered in Spanish may vary from year to year. It could be an elective or it could be a core class.

High School Program Information

- Dual Language Spanish will be offered each year.
- Foreign language credit is awarded for the course.
- Students are not required to take it all 4 years, but are encouraged to.
- All DL students will be expected to earn the Seal of Biliteracy at graduation.

Enrollment:

- Only students who are enrolled in Carthage R9 schools may apply.
- Transportation is provided only to students who qualify for the service in that building, so if you do not live in the Fairview attendance zone, you will need to provide transportation.
- Fairview applicants will fill the first 22 spaces for kindergarten enrollment. If the number of applicants exceeds 22, the applicants will be selected through lottery with the remainder being placed into the pool of other remaining applicants.

- The remaining 22 spaces will be filled from all remaining applicants. If there are more than 22 applicants, applicants will be selected through a lottery system that includes Fairview and boundary transfer students until all spaces are filled. The remaining applicants will be placed on a waiting list according to order drawn and by language dominance.
- The lottery (a drawing of student MOSIS or other district assigned numbers) will be witnessed by two unbiased parents and two unbiased district administrators.
- Siblings of current Carthage Dual Language Academy students who intend on enrolling in the program must complete an enrollment form prior to March 1. Enrollment is not automatic even though they have priority placement.
- Siblings of transfer students accepted into the program may attend Fairview if space allows (a standard school boundary transfer form must be filled out).

Important Dates:

March 5, 2024…….. Informational meeting for interested families

March 6, 2024 ……..Applications for Carthage Dual Language Academy Accepted

March 29, 2024……Deadline: Applications for Carthage Dual Language Academy in Fairview office

April 3, 2024……Lottery drawing for applicants and/or wait list(s)

April 8, 2024 ……Parent notification of placement in Carthage Dual Language Academy

April 19, 2024……Deadline for acceptance/enrollment

Student Language Assessment Dates: To be scheduled individually as needed

Curriculum Alignment Plan

Language Allocation per Subject Area/Grade Level

Grade Level	Language Arts/Literacy	Math	Social Studies/ Science	Specials (Computers, Art, Music, PE)
Kinder	50% English 50% Spanish	English	Spanish-Sci English- SS	English
Grade 1	50% English 50% Spanish	English	Spanish-Sci English-SS	English
Grade 2	50% English 50% Spanish	English	Spanish-Sci English -SS	English
Grade 3	50% English 50% Spanish	English	Spanish	English
Grade 4	80% English 20% Spanish	Spanish	English-SS Spanish-Sci	English
Grade 5	80% English 20% Spanish	Spanish	English-SS Spanish-Sci	English
Grade 6	90% English 10% Spanish	English	Spanish (both)	English
Grade 7-8	English Core Spanish Elective	Spanish Language Arts required Math is optional (Grade 7 only)		
Grade 9-10	Spanish Elective	Spanish language arts specific for dual language students		

<u>Contact Information:</u>

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